

Safe AI Use: The Anonymization Checklist

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Anonymization Checklist

Before using data with AI tools, ensure it's properly anonymized to protect privacy and comply with regulations. Use this checklist to guide your anonymization process.

- ☐ **Remove Names:** Replace names with pseudonyms or generic identifiers.
- ☐ **Remove Contact Information:** Delete or redact email addresses, phone numbers, and physical addresses.
- ☐ **Remove Identifying Details:** Eliminate unique identifiers such as social security numbers, employee IDs, and account numbers.
- ☐ **Use Ranges:** Convert precise numerical data (e.g., age, income) into broader ranges (e.g., 25-35, \$50,000-\$60,000).
- ☐ **Aggregate Data:** Combine individual data points into group-level summaries to obscure individual identities.
- ☐ **Remove Dates:** If dates are not essential, remove them. If needed, generalize to months or quarters.
- ☐ **Generalize Context:** Avoid specific details that could reveal identity through context (e.g., "the doctor on Elm Street" becomes "a healthcare professional").

Enterprise AI Tools: Safer Alternatives

Consider using enterprise versions of popular AI tools, which offer enhanced security and compliance features:

- **Microsoft Copilot Enterprise:** Offers enterprise-grade security, compliance, and data privacy. Integrates with Microsoft 365 applications.
- **ChatGPT Enterprise:** Provides enhanced data encryption, privacy controls, and compliance certifications. Designed for business use.
- **Claude for Work:** Focuses on data security and privacy, with features like secure data processing and access controls.

Important Note: Always check with your IT department for a list of approved AI tools and usage guidelines. Using unapproved tools may violate company policy and compromise data security.

